Cover Letter — International Journal of Project Management

Date: November 2026

To: The Editors, International Journal of Project Management

Subject: Submission of an original research article — “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”

Dear Editor,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”, for publication in *International Journal of Project Management*.

Project governance research separates the framework that assigns decision rights from the management of execution. When AI agents execute project work, that separation must hold at the moment of action. Following Design Science Research, this study designs and evaluates a human-in-the-loop governance framework for multi-agent, multi-platform delivery, implemented in two open-source artifacts, Agentic Work Lab and PublishOps CrossCast, and proposes reading stage gates as commit protocols in which approvals bind to content and irreversible steps happen at most once.

This study evaluates the framework in a nine-day field deployment (26 October–3 November 2026) in one creator–engineering laboratory. A 69-record operational journal records one platform write and no replayed upload; when Douyin's programmatic read-back timed out after the single final submission, the receipt stayed UNKNOWN, nothing was re-submitted, and the owner confirmed the work by phone. In one instrumented Instagram publication, 92.32% of the 412.217 s publish command was the wait after Share. The evaluated release software (PublishOps CrossCast, commit 75b7abc) carries 2,737 offline test functions, and 30 video versions (2.21 GB) are archived with recorded SHA-256 digests.

For IJPM readers, the contribution extends project governance and stage-gate theory to AI-executed project work and demonstrates a reporting protocol that keeps descriptive project evidence apart from causal claims about AI.

The study is a single-case design science evaluation. The manuscript states the assumptions under which automated re-submission cannot occur, reports every figure descriptively, keeps human-led and AI-assisted cohorts apart rather than comparing them causally, and publishes the data, code and a script that recomputes every reported figure.

The manuscript (11 tables, 5 figures, 3 algorithms, 50 references; 24 pages as a single-column PDF, 32 pages in the single-column LaTeX build) is accompanied by online supplementary material. It is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere.

Sincerely,

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